ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 8: **Follow That Dream; the poem on self-belief** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** letter from a mother to her daughter	Addressed to Ming.
2	**(c)** full encouragement	Go ahead.
3	**(b)** motivating	Encouraging.
4	**(a)** Ming	Ming is the daughter.
5	**(b)** a firm belief	Strong belief.
6	**(c)** a difficult task that tests ability	Definition.
7	**(b)** pursue her dream with effort	Encouragement.
8	**(b)** giving up something for a goal	Giving up.
9	**(a)** chasing dreams with courage and effort	Both.
10	**(c)** sustained effort	Hard work.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	A mother (1) writes to her daughter Ming (1).	1+1
12	Dreamers only wish (1) while achievers work and sacrifice (1).	1+1
13	Believing in oneself (1) and persevering despite difficulty (1).	1+1
14	Follow your dream (1) with hard work and sacrifice (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	A dream gives life direction (1). Effort turns it real (1). Regret comes from not trying (1).	1+1+1
16	Warm and wise (1). Encouraging but honest (1). The reader feels guided and inspired (1).	1+1+1
17	Both urge effort (1). Letter gives reasons (1). Poem gives images (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Dreams demand time (1). They demand sacrifice (1). Knowing this prepares Ming (1).	1+1+1
18	It starts with encouragement (1). It lists costs (1). It ends with support (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Mother told her to follow her dream (1). Command becomes an infinitive (1). 'Your' becomes 'her' (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Follow your dream (1). Work hard (1). Count the cost (1). Build support (1). Be flexible (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Belief in oneself (1). Perseverance (1). Not giving up (1). Challenges help growth (1). The poem inspires (1).	2+2+1
20	Loving (1). Wise (1). Realistic (1). Encouraging (1). A mentor (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Theme (1). Metaphor (1). Language (1). Mood (1). Your response (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Calling 'Follow That Dream' a diary or speech. It is a **letter from a mother to her daughter Ming**, so answers should say 'the mother advises'.
- Reducing the message to 'wish for it and it will come'. The letter says dreams are built through sustained effort, not luck or wishful thinking (hoping without acting).
- Forgetting the support network. The mother stresses that no one succeeds alone; family and friends help. A 'sacrifice' means giving up something for a goal, not a prize.
- Ignoring the fear of starting: beginning is hard because of the fear of failure, but a start must be made; self-belief gives courage to continue after setbacks.
- In the poem, calling 'comfort is a warm room' a simile. It is a **metaphor**; the theme is self-belief and perseverance, and the mood is encouraging.
- Usage slips: *Believe **in** yourself*, *She **has followed** her dream for years*, and *a* dream (consonant sound), not 'an dream'.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 8: **Follow That Dream; the poem on self-belief** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** love and realism	Balanced.
2	**(c)** persist	Persist.
3	**(c)** think about the time, effort and sacrifice involved	Be realistic.
4	**(d)** hoping without action	No action.
5	**(c)** She has followed her dream for years.	Present perfect.
6	**(a)** act and sacrifice	Action.
7	**(b)** self-belief and perseverance	The poem encourages belief in oneself and not giving up.
8	**(c)** Mother said that I could do it.	Backshift.
9	**(d)** support network	Help from others.
10	**(a)** keep trying despite difficulty	Perseverance.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Dreams may change with time (1) and this is natural (1).	1+1
12	It gives the courage to start (1) and the strength to continue after setbacks (1).	1+1
13	Think about the effort, time and sacrifice needed (1) before beginning (1).	1+1
14	Hoping for something without acting (1) so dreams stay dreams (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Long and steady (1). Disciplined (1). Combined with patience (1).	1+1+1
16	Fear holds us back (1). Belief overcomes it (1). Taking a first step reduces fear (1).	1+1+1
17	Ming has talent but she needs effort (1). 'But' joins the sentences (1). It shows contrast (1).	1+1+1
	OR: By encouraging (1). By sharing work (1). By giving comfort in failure (1).	1+1+1
18	Challenges seem big (1). They require leaving comfort (1). They test our belief (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Her determination was clear (1). Success needs sacrifice (1). Both words suit the theme (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Dreams need effort (1). Sacrifice of comfort (1). Patience (1). Examples (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Date (1). The dream (1). Fears (1). Decision (1). Hopes (1).	2+2+1
20	Format (1). Thanks (1). Her dream (1). Her plan (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Format (1). Greeting (1). The idea (1). Encouragement (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Calling 'Follow That Dream' a diary or speech. It is a **letter from a mother to her daughter Ming**, so answers should say 'the mother advises'.
- Reducing the message to 'wish for it and it will come'. The letter says dreams are built through sustained effort, not luck or wishful thinking (hoping without acting).
- Forgetting the support network. The mother stresses that no one succeeds alone; family and friends help. A 'sacrifice' means giving up something for a goal, not a prize.
- Ignoring the fear of starting: beginning is hard because of the fear of failure, but a start must be made; self-belief gives courage to continue after setbacks.
- In the poem, calling 'comfort is a warm room' a simile. It is a **metaphor**; the theme is self-belief and perseverance, and the mood is encouraging.
- Usage slips: *Believe **in** yourself*, *She **has followed** her dream for years*, and *a* dream (consonant sound), not 'an dream'.

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MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 8: **Follow That Dream; the poem on self-belief** | Class 9 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** cowardice	Cowardice.
2	**(d)** support	Others help.
3	**(d)** trap us	Limiting.
4	**(d)** in	Believe in.
5	**(b)** dreams may change as life changes	Flexibility.
6	**(a)** metaphor	Direct comparison.
7	**(a)** try something new and difficult	Idiom.
8	**(d)** encouraging and caring	Maternal.
9	**(d)** keep going towards a goal	Self-belief.
10	**(c)** Dream Big, Work Hard	Relevant.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	A warm room feels safe (1) but a closed door keeps us from growing (1).	1+1
12	No one succeeds alone (1) and family and friends help (1).	1+1
13	She encourages her daughter (1) and warns about cost and difficulty (1).	1+1
14	Take on challenges (1) and believe in yourself (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Life brings new experiences (1). Circumstances alter (1). A changed dream can still be valuable (1).	1+1+1
16	It speaks to the reader (1). It feels personal (1). It inspires action (1).	1+1+1
17	Work for your dream (1). Take the first step (1). Accept help and change (1).	1+1+1
	OR: They do not act (1). Their dreams stay dreams (1). They may regret later (1).	1+1+1
18	Comfort is like a warm room (1). It feels safe but closes the door (1). It stops growth (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Letter stresses effort (1). Poem stresses the first step (1). Together they turn wishes into action (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Introduction (1). Value of dreams (1). Role of effort (1). Example (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Letter: plan and sacrifice (1). Poem: first step and belief (1). Both urge action (1). Different forms (1). Together they guide (1).	2+2+1
20	Greeting (1). Letter's idea (1). Examples (1). Advice (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Introduction (1). Family (1). Friends and teachers (1). Examples (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

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- Reducing the message to 'wish for it and it will come'. The letter says dreams are built through sustained effort, not luck or wishful thinking (hoping without acting).
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